

ART & CULTURE



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

MODULE - 8

JAINISM- SECTS IN
JAINISM

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

- 1** The schism of Jainism into the two sects seems to have taken place in around 350 BCE.

DIGAMBARAS

(sky-clad or naked)

Leader
Bhadrabahu

SWETAMBARAS

(white-clad)

Leader
Sthulabahu

- 2** It is believed during the reign of Chandragupta Maurya when there was a 12 year of famine, Bhadrabahu, leading Jain Muni/scholar went to Karnataka, but on return to Magadha found differences with other Jains on the issue of acceptance of the Agamas and wearing of cloth.

- 3** This led to the emergence of the two different sects.

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

HOW DID JAINISM SPREAD TO SOUTH INDIA?

- 1** In order to spread the teachings of Jainism, Mahavira organized an order of followers which admitted both men and women.
- 2** Since, Jainism did not very clearly mark itself out from the Brahmanical religion, it failed to attract the masses.
- 3** Despite this, Jainism gradually spread into south and west India where the Brahmanical religion was weak.
- 4** According to a late tradition, the spread of Jainism in Karnataka is attributed to **Chandragupta Maurya**.
- 5** The emperor became a Jaina ascetic. But this tradition is not corroborated by any other source.
- 6** The second cause for the spread of Jainism in south India is said to be **the great famine** lasted for twelve years, and in order to protect themselves many a Jaina went to the south **under the leadership of Bhadrabahu**, but the rest of them stayed back in **Magadha** under the **leadership of Sthalabahu**.

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

HOW DID JAINISM SPREAD TO SOUTH INDIA?

- 7 The emigrant Jains spread Jainism in south india.
- 8 At the end of the famine they came back to Magadha, where they developed differences with the local jainas.
- 9 Those who came back from the south claimed that even during the famine they had strictly observed the religious rules; on the other hand, they alleged, the Jaina ascetics living in Magadha had violated those rules and had become lax.
- 10 In order to sort out these difference and to compile the main teachings of Jainism, a council was convened in Pataliputra, modern Patna, but the southern Jainas boycotted the council and refused to accept its decisions.
- 11 From now onwards, the southern began to be called Digambaras, and the Magadhans Shwetambaras.
- 12 The tradition which refers to drought as the cause belongs to a later period and is again considered doubtful.

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

HOW DID JAINISM SPREAD TO SOUTH INDIA?

JAIN COUNCILS

1 st JAIN COUNCIL	2 nd JAIN COUNCIL
300 BC	512 AD
Sthulabhadra	Devardhi Kshamasemana
Pataliputra	Vallabhi
12 Angas were compiled	New additions in the form of Upangas

13 But it is beyond doubt that the Jains were divided into two sects.

14 In subsequent centuries, especially after the 15th century, numerous Jaina monastic establishments called **basadis** sprang up in Karnataka and were granted land by the king for their support.



JAIN BASADIS OF KARNATAKA

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

HOW DID JAINISM SPREAD TO REST OF INDIA?

- 1 Jainism spread to **Kalinga in Orissa** in the 4th century B.C., and in the 1st century B.C. it enjoyed the patronage of the Kalinga **king Kharavela** who had defeated the princes of Andhra and Magadha.
- 2 In the 2nd and 1st centuries B.C. it also seems to have reached the **southern districts of Tamil Nadu**.
- 3 In later centuries Jainism **penetrated Malwa, Gujarat and Rajasthan**, and even now these areas have a good number of **Jainas who are mainly engaged in trade and commerce**.
- 4 Although Jainism **did not win as much state patronage as Buddhism did** and did not spread very fast in early times, **it still retains its hold in the areas where it spread**.
- 5 On the other hand, Buddhism practically disappeared from the Indian sub-continent (except for some places).

JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

DIFFERENCE IN THE TWO SECTS

1 While the Digambara sect prescribes living naked and not even having cloth as their possession, the Shwetambaras are clad in white clothes.



2 Digambaras do not consider the Agamas to contain the teachings of Mahavira and believe that they were lost in the famine but the Shwetambaras believe that the Agamas survived and they represent the teachings of Mahavira.



JAINISM

SECTS IN JAINISM

DIFFERENCE IN THE TWO SECTS

- 3 The Digambara sect also believes that **women cannot be Tirthankaras** or attain salvation on account of **not being able to practice complete renunciation, as they have to cover their body.**
- 4 This view is not held by the Shwetambaras.
- 5 They accord the **same status to women** who have renounced the world and who are referred as **sadhvis.**
- 6 They also believe that **Mallinath**, the 19th Tirthankara was a woman who attained salvation and thus women are not precluded from salvation.
- 7 However, Digambaras do not accept the **view of womanhood of Mallinath.**
- 8 However, the two sects do agree on basic tenets of Jainism, viz. Triratna, Panch-Mahavrat (five vows), Ahimsa, Anekantavada, etc.
- 9 Digambaras believe that **Mahavir was not married**, whereas Shvetambaras believe he was married.

JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

ASHTAMANGALA

These are eight auspicious symbols of Jainism and include:

1. SWASTIKA

2. SHRIVATSA

3. NANDAVARTA

4. MEEN YUGALA

5. KALASHA

6. VARDHAMANAKA

7. DARPANA

8. BHADRASANA



Bhadrasana



Darpana



Kalasha



Meen Yugala



Nandavarta



Shri Vatsa



Swastika 2



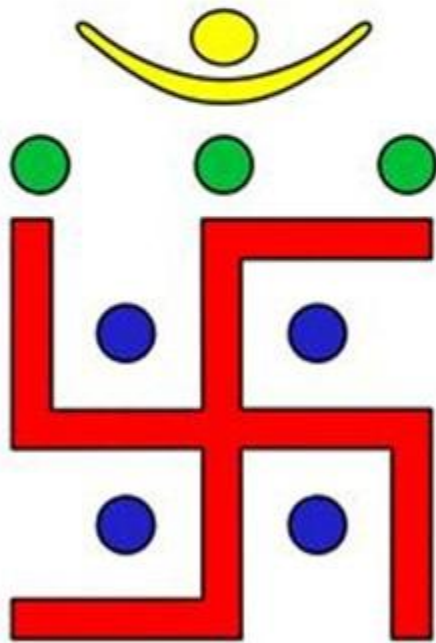
Vardhamanaka

- In Jain philosophy, symbols occupy an important place.
- However, **unlike Buddhism** they are not representative of life or events of any of the **Tirthankaras in particular** but signify abstract and metaphysical aspects, such as purity of soul, peace, well-being, wisdom, victory over carnal desire, etc.

JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

ASHTAMANGALA



1

SWASTIKA

- This is an auspicious symbol **signifying peace and well-being**.
- It is customarily drawn in places of worship and religious ceremonies.
- The four arms of the Swastika are also said to symbolise the **four categories of the world** (or the destiny of worldly beings based on Karma).
- These four categories include the heavenly being (**Deva**), human beings (**Manushya**), animals, birds, and plants (**Triyanch**), and hellish beings (**Narakvasi**).

JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

ASHTAMANGALA

2 SHRIVATSA

It is said to be a **mark on the chest** of Mahavira and other Tirthankaras which signifies **purity of soul, compassion, and love for all beings.**



3 NANDAVARTA

- The Nandavarta or Nandyavarta is one of the eight auspicious symbols of Jainism for the Svetambara sect.
- It serves as the visual icon for advanced meditative attainment.



JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

ASHTAMANGALA

4 MEEN YUGALA

- It is a figure of a fish couple.
- It is considered auspicious and signifying flow of divine life in the cosmic ocean.



5 KALASHA

It is a pot filled with holy water. It signifies purity and wisdom to fill our minds.



JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

ASHTAMANGALA

6 VARDHAMANAKA

It is an earthen bowl used as a lamp, symbolic of light (knowledge) **banishing darkness (ignorance)**

7 DARPANA

Mirror (Darpana) signifies reflection of **one's true self that is the soul**

8 BHADRASANA

It is a holy seat representing the seat of Mahavira and other venerated and liberated souls.



JAINISM

JAINISM AND SYMBOLS

THE JAIN EMBLEM

This is a congregation of several of the Jain symbols which has been accepted and adopted by all sects. It includes:



- a) The emblem's outline (signifying the universe and the other worlds).
- b) The Swastika
- c) The Jain palm symbol with Ahimsa (non-violence) inscribed at the bottom of the emblem, which means all life is bound together by mutual support and interdependence.

Thus, respect for life and others or the concepts of Ahimsa and Anekantavada are at the core of this philosophy.

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